Answer Key - History - K-12 Level Assessment 7 (Answers are ordered exactly as in the question paper.)

Multiple Choice

1. **Answer:** B
   Options: A) radiocarbon dating; B) dendrochronology; C) paleomagnetic dating; D) fission-track dating
   Note: Dendrochronology is the scientific method of dating trees by analyzing the growth rings, which reflect environmental conditions and can be used to establish chronological timelines in history.

2. **Answer:** D
   Options: A) cuneiform.; B) rachis.; C) mit'a.; D) khipu.
   Note: The khipu is the correct answer because it was an intricate system employed by the Inca civilization for recording information using colored knotted strings, serving as a mnemonic device for counting and documenting data.

3. **Answer:** D
   Options: A) Complex foragers employ irrigation technology.; B) Complex foragers rely on a wider range of food sources.; C) Complex foragers are more highly mobile.; D) Complex foragers focus on a few highly productive resources.
   Note: Complex foragers concentrate their efforts on a limited number of resource types that yield higher returns, whereas simple foragers tend to gather a wider variety of resources without the same level of specialization.

4. **Answer:** C
   Options: A) steadily improved.; B) steadily worsened.; C) changed only slightly.; D) evolved into a more sophisticated technology.
   Note: Hand axe technology remained relatively consistent during this period, reflecting a stable design and function that effectively met the needs of early human populations.

5. **Answer:** B
   Options: A) first writing; Amratian Period; B) first cities; Uruk Period]; C) first religious specialists; New Temple Period; D) first permanent military; Nagada I Period
   Note: The development of civilization in Mesopotamia is characterized by the emergence of the first cities during the Uruk Period, which marked a significant transition from nomadic lifestyles to settled urban societies with complex social structures and economies.

True / False

6. **Answer:** False
   Options: A) True; B) False

Note: Frere's discovery involved flint tools found beneath the remains of extinct animals, indicating that the tools were created by early humans who lived during the same period as these animals.

7. **Answer:** False
   Options: A) True; B) False
   Note: The statement is false because the paleoanthropological perspective does not specifically address the age of the Earth, which is a concept primarily rooted in geology rather than anthropology.

8. **Answer:** True
   Options: A) True; B) False
   Note: Ground-penetrating radar, proton magnetometer, and electrical resistivity are all non-invasive techniques that archaeologists use to detect and analyze subsurface archaeological features without excavating, making them valuable remote-sensing tools in the field.

9. **Answer:** True
   Options: A) True; B) False
   Note: The statement is true because archaeological evidence indicates that the Ancestral Puebloans established a complex society in Chaco Canyon, characterized by a significant number of large settlement structures and numerous smaller communities that supported their cultural and economic activities.

10. **Answer:** True
    Options: A) True; B) False
    Note: Mohenjo-daro is considered a complex urban center of the Mature Harappan period because it featured advanced city planning, sophisticated drainage systems, and a variety of social and economic activities that indicate a high level of societal organization and development.

Long Form Response

11. **Answer:** Homo habilis, often referred to as the "handy man," played a crucial role in the development of early human societies primarily through the creation and use of stone tools. This species, which lived approximately 2.4 to 1.4 million years ago, is notable for its ability to craft simple stone tools, marking a significant advancement in human evolution. The use of these tools allowed Homo habilis to access a wider range of food sources, such as meat and plants, which contributed to their survival and growth. Moreover, the development of tool-making skills likely fostered social interactions and cooperation among early humans, as individuals worked together to create and utilize these tools effectively. Thus, Homo habilis represents a foundational step in the advancement of human culture and technology.
    Note: correct because it emphasizes Homo habilis's role in early human societies through the innovative creation and use of stone tools, which enhanced their ability to obtain diverse food sources and improve survival.

12. **Answer:** Fire has played a crucial role in human evolution by significantly enhancing the digestibility of food, particularly meat. When meat is cooked over fire, it becomes easier to chew and break down, allowing our ancestors to extract more nutrients from their meals. Additionally, cooking food with fire kills harmful bacteria and parasites that can cause illness, leading to improved health. This not only allowed early humans to thrive but also contributed to the development of larger brains, as a better diet supported increased cognitive functions. Socially, the control of fire fostered communal cooking and sharing of meals, strengthening social bonds and cooperation within groups. Overall, fire was a transformative tool that shaped both our biology and social structures.
    Note: correct because it highlights how cooking food with fire increases its digestibility, enhances nutrient absorption, reduces health risks from pathogens, and ultimately supports human evolution by enabling the development of larger brains and healthier societies.

End of Answer Key